

Dakota Rennels

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Scientist and AI Engineering leader with deep experience designing, deploying, and operating production-grade ML and GenAI systems in complex enterprise environments. Proven track record owning end-to-end AI platforms, including data pipelines, model development, MLOps/LLMOps, and Kubernetes-based infrastructure. Strong background in distributed systems, API architecture, and real-time analytics, with hands-on expertise across CI/CD, containerization, GPU-backed clusters, and high-availability services. Operates as a hybrid staff-level IC and people leader, translating ambiguous business problems into scalable AI solutions with measurable impact. Former key technical advisor on the Governor's AI Task Force, contributing to AI strategy, governance, and large-scale adoption.

EXPERIENCE

Interim Manager / Sr. Data Scientist Paycom, Oklahoma

03/2024 - Current

- Serve as Interim Team Lead and Acting Manager, overseeing and mentoring senior and junior data scientists across multiple operational domains while maintaining staff-level hands-on technical ownership.
- Architect, build, and operate end-to-end AI/ML platforms supporting real-time financial systems, revenue forecasting, intelligent automation, and AI-driven decision support.
- Own production infrastructure and SDLC across Dev, QA, Staging, and Production, leveraging GitLab CI/CD, Docker, Helm, and Kubernetes in a predominantly on-prem environment.
- Design and deploy LLM-powered systems for conversational AI, document intelligence, and automation workflows, including model serving, observability, and lifecycle management.
- Lead adoption of event-driven architectures by integrating Kafka into core data engineering and ML workflows, improving scalability and data freshness.
- Establish and enforce MLOps and LLMOps best practices, ensuring model reliability, monitoring, retraining, and high availability in production.
- Recognized for translating complex, cross-functional business problems into well-scoped, high-impact data science and AI initiatives.

Sr. Data Scientist – Team Lead

01/2022 – 03/2024

Oklahoma Office of Management and Enterprise Services, Oklahoma

- Pioneered the first Conversational GenAI chatbot deployed within the U.S. public sector, setting architectural and governance standards for enterprise AI adoption.
- Built and led multi-team ML infrastructure initiatives, enabling real-time model deployment and shared AI services across multiple agencies.
- Designed and deployed Kubernetes-based ML serving architectures using FastAPI and TensorFlow Serving, supporting low-latency, high-availability inference.
- Developed a distributed, high-availability feature store, reducing production inference latency by 40%.
- Implemented predictive survival models for statewide fleet management, improving maintenance forecasting and asset lifecycle planning.
- Delivered ML-powered OCR and image recognition systems with geospatial tagging to support infrastructure condition assessment and optimized maintenance spending.
- Implemented A/B testing, continuous retraining pipelines, and drift detection, improving long-term model performance and reliability.
- Owned technical strategy for ML platform scalability, observability, and data infrastructure modernization.

Sr. Data Analyst – Sales Operations
Vail Resorts, Colorado

10/2020 – 03/2024

- Built and operationalized data science workflows for sales analytics, forecasting, and competitive intelligence.
- Conducted risk analysis and QA on internal and external sales systems to ensure data integrity and reporting accuracy.
- Designed improved competitive analysis frameworks and partnered with marketing teams to enable adoption and training.
- Led process modernization using CRISP-DM and DAMA-DMBOK II, improving consistency and governance of transactional analytics.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, SQL, R, GraphQL, PHP
- **Data & Streaming:** Kafka, Spark, Airflow, Delta Lake
- **AI / ML:** Machine Learning, Deep Learning, LLMs, Vector Databases, RAG, Agentic Systems
- **MLOps / LLMops:** MLflow, Kubeflow, Arize, Ray
- **Infrastructure:** Linux, Docker, Helm, Kubernetes, GPU Clusters
- **Cloud:** AWS, GCP, Azure
- **Databases:** Neo4j, Milvus, Qdrant, MySQL, SQL Server
- **Other:** CI/CD, Git, API Design, Observability, Data Governance, Technical Leadership

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Advanced Data Analytics
Deep Learning & AI
University of North Texas

12/2023

Bachelor of Science, Data Analytics
Computer Science and Statistics
University of North Texas

07/2022

Chemical Engineering/Biochemistry
University of Oklahoma

08/2012 - 05/2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Cloud Practitioner Certification
- Google Generative AI for Developers
- Google Encoder-Decoder Architecture
- IBM/Darden Title Specialization
- Certified Analytics Professional Expert (CAP-X)

AWARDS/RECOGNITIONS

- **Ranked #1 of 1,391** — Master's Program, University of North Texas
- **Ranked #1 of 1,197** — Undergraduate Program, University of North Texas
- **President's Honor Roll** — Spring 2022, Fall 2021